India’s dependence on military assistance from an ally is bound to be higher in the event of its involvement in a two-front war, irrespective of whether it is China or Pakistan that joins the fray. While the scope and intensity of Chinese military operations would probably remain the same because of the geopolitical and geographical constraints highlighted earlier, the territorial and security consequences of fighting China in a two-front war are likely to be high. America does have the capacity to provide greater military support for India under these circumstances. At the same time, Russia, the only other alternative external balancer for India, is no longer interested in playing that role. In the Treaty of Good Neighbourliness and Friendly Cooperation that it signed with China in 2001, Russia undertook not to “enter into an alliance or a treaty with a third country” and to engage in consultations for the purpose of eliminating any “threat of aggression” that China might confront.[116] Further, the combination of the rupture in its relationship with the West over the absorption of Crimea and economic difficulties ushered in by declining oil prices are compelling Russia to forge a closer partnership with China, including the integration of its Eurasian Economic Union (EAEU) project with China’s Belt and Road Initiative.[117] In effect, the earlier “marriage of convenience” between Russia and China is now becoming an “entente,” with the two countries sharing “not only a host of fundamental interests but also, increasingly, elements of a common worldview.”[118] In effect, India’s military dependence on America is likely to be higher in the event of a two-front war with China. But would America be willing to come to India’s assistance? What kind of military assistance and risks associated with it would America be willing to take? Would whatever assistance America may be willing to offer be sufficient for India to adequately tackle the threat from China? Answers to these